

1 · WHAT BASEOUT IS

"Baseout is the backup, restore, and data intelligence layer for Airtable — giving platform admins real-time protection, schema visibility, and direct SQL access to their own data."

B2B SaaS utility that automatically backs up Airtable (schema, records, attachments, plus user-submitted automations/interfaces) to customer-controlled or Baseout-managed storage, provides restore, and layers on data intelligence: schema visualization & changelogs, base health scoring, documentation, analytics, and — on higher tiers — a live SQL copy of the customer's data with API access. V1 is Airtable-only; the architecture is built for multi-platform expansion (Notion, HubSpot, Salesforce) with per-platform subscriptions under one billing relationship.

2 · BUSINESS CONTEXT — A RELAUNCH, NOT A COLD START

Baseout is the full rebrand and next-gen replacement of **On2Air Backups**: ~200 paying customers (anchored at \$9.99–\$79.99/mo) migrate onto Baseout tiers. On2Air was, by the team's own assessment, **historically underpriced relative to value**. A detailed migration plan already exists (year-1 bridge pricing, two non-public plans, migration credit grants) that new pricing must stay compatible with. Competitive set is thin: Airtable's native snapshots (free, but not an external/governed copy), Whalesync, Coefficient, DIY scripts. Claimed differentiators: most storage destinations in market (only OneDrive support) and unique **BYOS/BYODB** — on static bring-your-own-storage plans, record data *never touches Baseout servers*.

3 · THE ARCHITECTURE SPLIT THAT SHAPES ALL PRICING

	STATIC BACKUP	DYNAMIC BACKUP
What	Flat-file export (CSV) per run to a storage destination	Data synced into a managed database (D1 → Shared PG → Dedicated PG → BYODB by tier)
Privacy	On BYOS, data never stored on Baseout servers	Customer explicitly opts in to hosted storage
Cost shape	Re-transfers full dataset every run — scales with volume × frequency	Big initial sync, cheap incremental deltas, ongoing storage at rest
Unlocks	Backup + restore only	SQL access, APIs, real-time sync, and all data-intelligence capabilities

The dynamic database ladder is simultaneously a **capability gate**, a **COGS driver**, and a **privacy trade-off** the customer is compensated for with features. All differentiation beyond "backup tool" requires it.

4 · FEATURE SET — NINE TIER-GATED CAPABILITIES

CAPABILITY	CONTENTS	AVAILABILITY
Backup (core)	Scheduled monthly→weekly→daily→instant(webhook); manual runs; static+dynamic; 7+ destinations; restore (base/table, point-in-time, to new data); audit reports; smart cleanup	All tiers; frequency/mode/restores gated
Schema	Auto ERD visualization; changelog (30d→24mo); health score w/ audit rules; rich-text Documents; AI docs; diagram export PNG→SVG→PDF→embed	Basic on Trial; full Launch+; AI Pro+
Data	Record dashboards, data changelog, growth trends, alerts (5/25/∞ rules), insights, PII detection	Launch+ · requires dynamic
Automations / Interfaces	Backup + changelog + docs + insights (user-submitted intake; Airtable API doesn't expose them)	Launch+ · requires dynamic
AI	AI docs & schema insights (V1); MCP server, RAG, chatbot, vector DB (V2); BYO model	Pro+ docs · Business+ rest (V2)
Analytics	Usage metrics, trend charts, custom reports (5/∞) & dashboards (3/∞), scheduled delivery	Basic all · full Business+
Governance	Quality rules, classification, lineage, retention policy, access controls, SOC 2/GDPR tooling	Business+ · entirely V2
Integrations	Inbound API (Growth+), SQL REST API (Pro+), Direct SQL (Business+), Zapier/Make (V2), writeback (V2)	Growth+ ladder

Customer model: Organization (billing entity, one Stripe subscription) → Spaces (unit of configuration, each with its own backup config, database + storage destination) → Bases. Spaces, bases/Space, connections, and seats are all counted resources. **Primary buyer:** the Airtable platform admin — internal IT/RevOps owners and consultants managing multiple client orgs.

5 · THE DESIGNED PRICING MODEL SPEC — NOT YET IN CODE

	TRIAL	LAUNCH	GROWTH	PRO	BUSINESS	ENTERPRISE
Monthly / annual-equiv price	\$0	\$49 / \$39	\$99 / \$79	\$199 / \$159	\$399 / \$319	Custom
Transfer credits / mo	1,000	15,000	40,000	120,000	400,000	Custom
Credit overage rate	pauses	\$0.007	\$0.006	\$0.005	\$0.004	Negotiated
Effective \$/credit (monthly)	—	\$0.0039	\$0.0025	\$0.0017	\$0.0010	—
Backup frequency	Monthly	Weekly	Weekly	Daily	Daily + Instant	Daily + Instant
Database (dynamic)	D1 schema-only	D1 full	D1 full	Shared PG	Dedicated PG	BYODB
R2 storage / DB storage	250MB / 100MB	5GB / 1GB	20GB / 5GB	75GB / 25GB	250GB / 100GB	Custom
Snapshot retention	30 days	90 days	6 mo	12 mo	24 mo	Custom
Spaces · bases/Space	1 · 1	3 · 3	∞ · ∞	∞ · ∞	∞ · ∞	∞ · ∞
Seats · restores/mo · manual runs	1 · 1 · 0	3 · 2 · 2	5 · 3 · 5	10 · 5 · ∞	15 · 15 · ∞	∞ · ∞ · ∞

No free tier — trial only (per PRD: 7 days AND 1 backup run, data-capped, no card; \$0 Stripe subscription swapped on upgrade). **Non-public plans:** Starter \$29/mo (5,000 cr, hidden entry plan) and On2Air Bridge \$9.99/mo (migration-only, year 1). **PAYG packs** \$10–\$150 at deliberately unattractive rates (\$0.0100–0.0125/cr). Annual ≈ 20% off.

Credit system (the usage meter)

OPERATION	CREDITS
Schema backup (per base/run)	5
Records (per 1,000)	1
Attachments (per 50 MB)	1
Restore: table / base / base+attach	15 / 40 / 75
Manual backup or cleanup trigger	10
AI doc gen / AI schema insight	10 / 5
Inbound API (per 100) / SQL REST (per 50)	1 / 1

Credits reset monthly, no rollover; rates DB-stored (tunable without deploys). Multi-bucket design: plan, add-on, **onboarding** (30-day, absorbs the 200x-cost first backup), purchased (12-mo), promotional, migration — consumed soonest-expiring first over an immutable ledger. Per-org overage mode: **auto-bill or hard cap** (default cap) + 50/75/90/100% alerts.

Overage & expansion revenue

ITEM	PRICE
R2 storage overage	\$0.50 /GB/mo
DB storage overage (D1/Shared/Dedicated)	\$1 / \$2 / \$3 /GB/mo
Recurring credit add-ons (+5K→+150K/mo)	\$25–\$420/mo
One-time credit blocks (5K→200K)	\$30–\$700
Storage add-ons (+10→+250 GB R2)	\$4–\$130/mo
Extra seats (Starter→Pro)	\$6–\$12 /seat/mo

Rate ladder is engineered: each tier's effective \$/credit beats the tier below; add-ons beat overage; plans beat add-ons — every path points to **upgrade**. Stripe: one subscription/org, one item/platform, capabilities resolved from product metadata; multi-platform discount (15–20%, TBD) reserved for V2.

6 · PRICING LEVERS AVAILABLE

CLASS	LEVERS
Usage meters	Transfer credits (primary value metric — volume × frequency), R2 GB, DB GB, API calls, SQL queries, restores/mo, manual runs, AI operations
Capacity limits	Spaces (consultant magnet: unlimited at \$99), bases/Space, connections, seats (deliberately secondary — few users per admin account)
Capability gates	Backup frequency = RPO = cleanest WTP proxy ; DB-engine ladder; retention; cleanup policy sophistication; destinations (S3 Growth+, custom BYOS Pro+); capability on/off + quantity sub-gates (alert rules, reports, dashboards); notification channels; diagram export; support level; SSO/SOC 2/BYODB
Commercial constructs	Annual ~20%; onboarding credits; hard-cap default; add-on/block/PAYG ladder; non-public plans; migration pricing + credit grants; per-platform trials; multi-platform discount (V2)

7 · COST STRUCTURE

Fully serverless/usage-based stack — near-zero COGS at rest, scales with activity: Cloudflare Workers + Durable Objects (web, engine, per-connection rate limiting, per-Space scheduling), Trigger.dev v3 (per-second compute for backup tasks), DigitalOcean PostgreSQL master DB, Cloudflare D1/R2/KV/Email, Workers AI, Stripe (~2.9% + 30¢), PostHog, dub.co. The Airtable API is free — its rate limits, not dollars, are the constraint.

Margin anchors (early-2026 list prices — verify)

ITEM	PRICE VS COST
R2 storage overage	\$0.50 vs ~\$0.015/GB/mo → ~97% margin
D1 DB overage	\$1.00 vs ~\$0.75/GB/mo → ~25% — thin
Credit-metered activity	Generally 10–100× marginal infra cost
Restore / API / email	Near-zero marginal cost (R2 has zero egress)
Enterprise BYODB	Cheapest tier to serve — margin is support/compliance, not COGS

Structural cost notes

- **Storage persists; credits reset** — retention-heavy tiers accrue COGS monthly; Smart Cleanup is the containment feature (not yet built).
- **Dynamic incremental sync is cheaper for Baseout AND customer** — the credit model nudges users toward the mode that also unlocks upsell.
- **Step costs:** support (chat at Business, CSM/SLA at Enterprise) and SOC 2 certification (prereq for selling Business+).

⚠ **BIGGEST STRUCTURAL MARGIN RISK** — Business tier (\$399/mo) includes a **dedicated PostgreSQL instance per Space** (~\$19–60+/mo COGS each) **with unlimited Spaces**. Ten Spaces could cost more to serve than the subscription earns. Options: cap included dedicated-DB Spaces, provision per-Organization instead of per-Space, or price extra dedicated-DB Spaces as an add-on.

8 · REALITY CHECK — SPEC VS. SHIPPED CODE (JULY 2026)

✓ Built & working

- Backup pipeline end-to-end: OAuth, scheduled (per-Space DO alarms) + manual runs, per-base Trigger.dev tasks, CSV + attachment export w/ dedup, run history/cancel/delete, per-connection rate limiting
- Destinations: managed R2, Google Drive, Dropbox, Box, OneDrive (S3/Frame.io stubbed)
- Stripe skeleton: customer + subscription at signup, 7-day/1-run trial enforcement, subscription-item-per-platform, tier resolution
- Tier gating in code: frequency, bases/Space, schema-docs level
- Auth (magic link), dashboard, integrations/destinations UI, schema browsing, staff admin console

✗ Designed but NOT implemented

- **Entire credit system** — no buckets, ledger, rates, or consumption logic; code has a simpler overage table that nothing populates
- **Overage metering/billing** — revenue leakage until built
- **Restore** — placeholder page only (a headline feature of every tier)
- **Retention/cleanup** — storage grows unbounded (COGS risk)
- **Dynamic DB provisioning, webhooks/instant, Inbound API, SQL REST, Direct SQL** — placeholder Workers
- Seat/storage quota enforcement; analytics; health score UI

Sequencing decision: launch pricing can (a) start with what's enforceable today — flat tiers + frequency + bases caps + trial — layering credits/overage in later, or (b) hold launch for the credit meter. The gap between designed and enforceable models is currently large. Code tier limits also drift from spec (e.g., bases/Space 5/10/15/25/50 vs spec 1/3/3/∞) — treat code values as provisional.

9 · OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE PRICING ENGAGEMENT

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|--|---|
| 1. Trial: 7-day/1-run (PRD, in code) vs persistent \$0 tier w/ 1,000 cr/mo (Features)? | 2. Dynamic storage credits (2cr/1K rec, 5cr/GB monthly) contradict "credits meter transfer only" — which wins? Changes dynamic economics materially. |
| 3. Dedicated-PG-per-Space × unlimited Spaces at Business — cap, restructure, or reprice? | 4. Is \$49 the right public floor given ~200 legacy customers anchored at \$9.99–\$29.99 (+ hidden \$29 plan)? |
| 5. Launch price: \$49 (tier table) vs \$59 (resolution note) — typo to settle. | 6. Does the consultant/agency segment need client-count packaging vs riding Growth? |
| 7. Instant backup at Pro+ (PRD) or Business+ (Features)? Same conflict on Automations/Interfaces min tier. | 8. Unresolved spec items: Enterprise qualification floor, default overage cap multiple, incremental-sync "changed record" definition, attachment MB measurement point, multi-platform discount %. |

Sources: shared/Baseout_Features.md v1.1 (authoritative pricing), shared/Pricing_Credit_System.md, shared/Baseout_PRD.md v1.1/1.4, shared/Baseout_Implementation_Plan.md, plus full codebase audit (apps/web, server, workflows, api, sql, hooks, admin). Full detail: overview/pricing/Baseout_Pricing_Strategy_Briefing.md.